

Chapter 1

Demo problem: How to create refineable meshes in domains with curvilinear and/or moving boundaries

In an [earlier example](#) we demonstrated how easy it is to "upgrade" an existing quad mesh to a `RefineableMesh` that can be used with `oomph-lib`'s mesh adaptation routines. The "upgrade" was achieved by multiple inheritance: We combined the basic (non-refineable) mesh object with `oomph-lib`'s `RefineableQuadMesh` – a class that implements the required mesh adaptation procedures, using `QuadTree` - based refinement techniques for meshes that contain quadrilateral elements. During the refinement process, selected elements are split into four "son" elements and the nodal values and coordinates of any newly created nodes are determined by interpolation from the "father" element. This procedure is perfectly adequate for problems with polygonal domain boundaries in which the initial coarse mesh provides a perfect representation of the domain. The situation is more complicated in problems with curvilinear domain boundaries since we must ensure that successive mesh refinements lead to an increasingly accurate representation of the domain boundary.

To illustrate these issues we (re-)consider the 2D Poisson problem

Two-dimensional model Poisson problem in a non-trivial domain

Solve

$$\sum_{i=1}^2 \frac{\partial^2 u}{\partial x_i^2} = -1, \quad (1)$$

in the fish-shaped domain D_{fish} with homogeneous Dirichlet boundary conditions

$$u|_{\partial D_{fish}} = 0. \quad (2)$$

In Part 1 of this document we shall explain how `oomph-lib`'s mesh adaptation procedures employ the `Domain` and `MacroElement` objects to adapt meshes in domains with curvilinear boundaries. In Part 2, we demonstrate how to create new `Domain` objects.

1.1 Part 1: Mesh adaptation in domains with curvilinear boundaries, using Domain and MacroElement objects

The plot below shows the domain D_{fish} , represented by the multi-coloured, shaded region and its (extremely coarse) discretisation with four four-node quad elements. The elements' edges and nodes are shown in black.

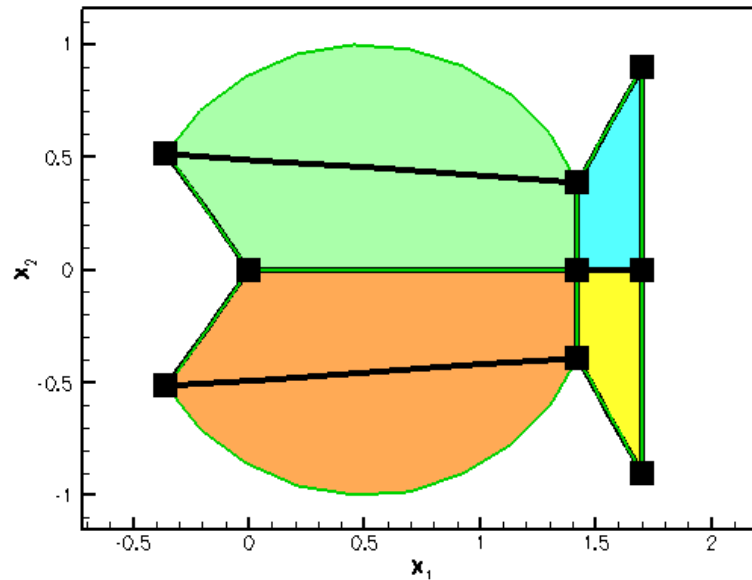


Figure 1.1 The fish-shaped domain and its discretisation with four four-node quad elements

Obviously, the curvilinear boundaries of the fish-shaped domain (arcs of circles) are very poorly resolved by the elements' straight edges. Simple mesh adaptation, based on the techniques described in the [earlier example](#) will not result in convergence to the exact solution since the refined mesh never approaches the exact domain geometry:

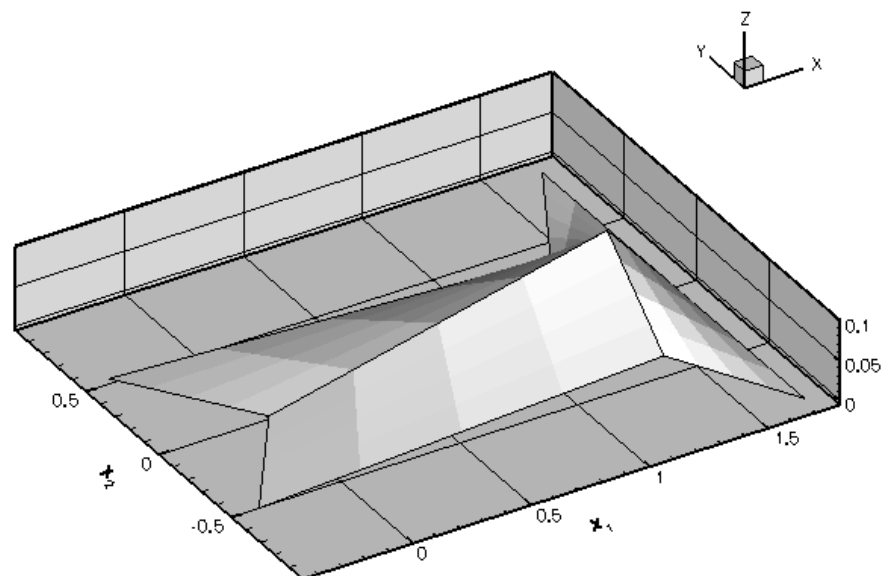


Figure 1.2 Plot of the mesh adaptation without MacroElements

To overcome this problem, the mesh adaptation routines must be given access to an exact, analytical representation of the actual domain. This is the purpose of oomph-lib's `Domain` object. A `Domain` provides an analytical description of a mathematical domain, by decomposing it into a number of so-called `MacroElements`. Each `MacroElement` provides a mapping between a set of local and global coordinates $\mathbf{r}_{macro}(\mathbf{s})$ – similar to the mapping between the local and global coordinates in a finite element. The key difference between the two types of element is that the `MacroElement` mapping resolves curvilinear domain boundaries exactly, whereas the finite element mapping interpolates the global coordinates between the coordinates of its nodes. The topology of `MacroElements` mirrors that of the associated (geometric) finite elements: For instance, the `QMacroElement` family is the counterpart of the `QElement` family of geometric finite elements. Both are templated by the spatial dimension, and the local coordinates (in their right-handed local coordinate systems) are in the range between -1 and +1.

The different-coloured, shaded regions in the above sketch represent the four two-dimensional `QMacroElements` by which the `FishDomain` represents the fish-shaped domain D_{fish} . For instance, `MacroElement 0` (shown in orange) represents the lower half of the fish's body; within this `MacroElement`, the curved "belly" is represented by the line $\mathbf{r}_{macro}(s_0, s_1 = -1)$ for $s_0 \in [-1, 1]$; the lower "jaw" is represented by $\mathbf{r}_{macro}(s_0 = -1, s_1)$ for $s_1 \in [-1, 1]$; etc.

To illustrate the use of `MacroElements` / `Domains`, the following code fragment (from

`fish_mesh.template.cc`) demonstrates how the constructor of the original, non-refineable `FishMesh` assigns the nodal positions. Each of the `FishDomain`'s four `QMacroElements` is associated with one of the four finite elements in the mesh. Since both types of elements are parametrised by the same local coordinate systems, we determine the position of the node that is located at (s_0, s_1) (in the finite element's local coordinate system) from the corresponding `MacroElement` mapping, $\mathbf{r}_{macro}(s_0, s_1)$:

```
// Create elements and all nodes in element
//-----
// (ignore repetitions for now -- we'll clean them up later)
//-----
for (unsigned e = 0; e < nelem; e++)
{
    // Create element
    Element_pt[e] = new ELEMENT;

    // Loop over rows in y/s_1-direction
    for (unsigned i1 = 0; i1 < n_node_1d; i1++)
    {
        // Loop over rows in x/s_0-direction
        for (unsigned i0 = 0; i0 < n_node_1d; i0++)
        {
            // Local node number
            unsigned j_local = i0 + i1 * n_node_1d;

            // Create the node and store pointer to it
            Node* node_pt =
                finite_element_pt(e)->construct_node(j_local, time_stepper_pt);

            // Work out the node's coordinates in the finite element's local
            // coordinate system:
            finite_element_pt(e)->local_fraction_of_node(j_local, s_fraction);

            s[0] = -1.0 + 2.0 * s_fraction[0];
            s[1] = -1.0 + 2.0 * s_fraction[1];

            // Get the global position of the node from macro element mapping
            Domain_pt->macro_element_pt(e)->macro_map(s, r);

            // Set the nodal position
            node_pt->x(0) = r[0];
            node_pt->x(1) = r[1];
        }
    }
} // end of loop over elements
```

This technique ensures that the mesh's boundary nodes are placed on the exact domain boundary when the mesh is created.

To retain this functionality during the mesh adaptation, each `FiniteElement` provides storage for a pointer to an associated `MacroElement`. By default, the `MacroElement` pointer is set to `NULL`, indicating that the element is not associated with a `MacroElement`. In that case, the coordinates of newly created nodes are determined by interpolation from the father element, as discussed above. If the `MacroElement` pointer is non-`NULL`, the refinement process refers to the element's `MacroElement` representation to determine the new nodal positions. To enable the mesh adaptation process to respect the domain's curvilinear boundaries, each element in the coarse base mesh must therefore be given a pointer to its associated `MacroElement`, e.g. by using the following loop:

```
// Loop over all elements and set macro element pointer
unsigned n_element = this->nelement();
for (unsigned e = 0; e < n_element; e++)
```

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```
{
    // Get pointer to element
    FiniteElement* el_pt = this->finite_element_pt(e);

    // Set pointer to macro element to enable MacroElement-based
    // remesh. Also enables the curvilinear boundaries
    // of the mesh/domain get picked up during adaptive
    // mesh refinement in derived classes.
    el_pt->set_macro_elem_pt(this->Domain_pt->macro_element_pt(e));
}
```

Once the mesh is aware of the curvilinear boundaries, each level of mesh refinement produces a better representation of the curvilinear domain, ensuring the convergence to the exact solution:

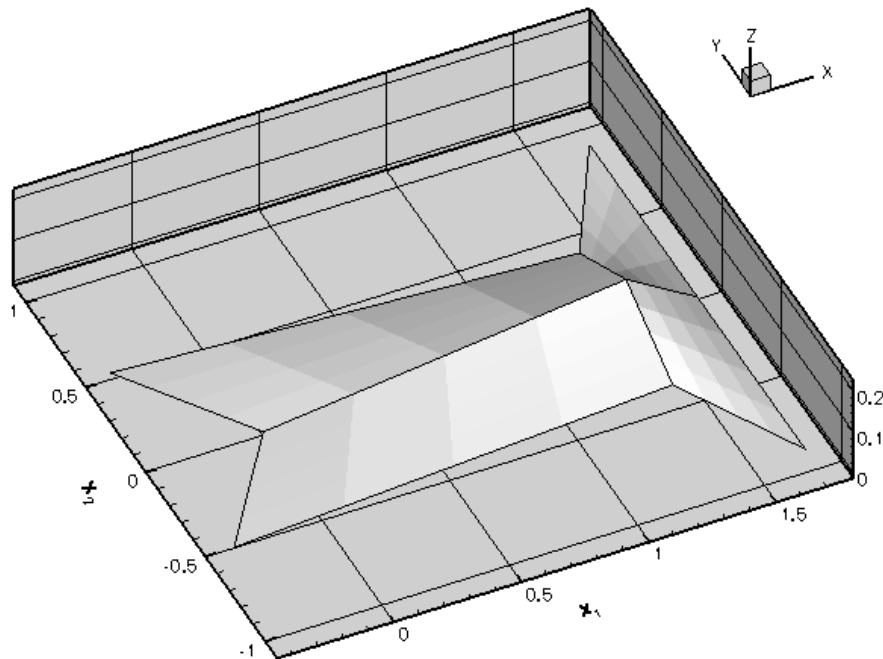


Figure 1.3 Plot of the mesh adaptation with MacroElements

The results shown in this animation were computed with the demo code `fish_poisson_adapt.cc` – a simple modification of the code

`fish_poisson.cc` that we used in the [earlier example](#). The only difference between the two codes is that in the present example, the `FishDomain` is discretised with four-node rather than nine-node `RefineableQPoiss` elements to highlight the inadequacy of the basic mesh refinement process. Note that, as a result of lower accuracy of the four-node elements, we require a much finer discretisation in the interior of the domain.

1.2 Part 2: How to represent domains with curvilinear boundaries by Domain and MacroElement objects

The above example demonstrated that "upgrading" existing meshes to `RefineableMeshes` that can be used with `oomph-lib`'s mesh adaptation procedures, can be achieved in two trivial steps:

1. Associate each `RefineableQElement` with a `QuadTree` – this can be done completely automatically by calling the function `RefineableQuadMesh::setup_quadtree_forest()`.
2. If the problem's domain has curvilinear boundaries, associate each `RefineableQElement` with a `MacroElement` – defined in the `Domain` object that provides an analytical representation of the domain.

While this looks (and indeed is) impressively simple, we still have to explain how to create `Domain` objects. We start by introducing yet another useful `oomph-lib` class, the `GeomObject`.

1.2.1 The geometric object, GeomObject

As the name suggests, `GeomObjects` are `oomph-lib` objects that provide an analytical description/parametrisation of geometric objects. Mathematically, `GeomObjects` define a mapping from a set of "Lagrangian" (intrinsic) coordinates to the global "Eulerian" coordinates of the object. The number of Lagrangian and Eulerian coordinates can differ. For instance, the unit circle, centred at the origin may be parametrised by a single coordinate, ξ (representing the polar angle), as

$$\mathbf{r}_{circle} = \begin{pmatrix} \cos \xi \\ \sin \xi \end{pmatrix},$$

while a 2D disk may be parametrised by two coordinates ξ_1 and ξ_2 (representing the radius and the polar angle, respectively) as

$$\mathbf{r}_{disk} = \xi_1 \begin{pmatrix} \cos \xi_2 \\ \sin \xi_2 \end{pmatrix}.$$

All specific `GeomObjects` must implement the pure virtual function `GeomObject::position(...)` which computes the Eulerian position vector $\mathbf{r}$ as a function of the (vector of) Lagrangian coordinates ξ . (The `GeomObject` base class also provides interfaces for a multitude of other functions, such as functions that compute the spatial and temporal derivatives of the position vector. These functions are implemented as "broken" virtual functions and their implementation is optional; see the [earlier example](#) for a discussion of "broken" virtual functions.)

Here is a complete example of a specific `GeomObject`:

```
//=====start_of_unit_circle=====
/// Unit circle in 2D, centred at the origin, parametrised by a single
/// Lagrangian coordinate, the polar angle.
//=====
class UnitCircle : public GeomObject
{
public:

    /// Constructor: Pass the number of Lagrangian
    /// and Eulerian coordinates to the constructor of the
    /// GeomObject base class.
    UnitCircle() : GeomObject(1,2) {}

    /// Destructor -- empty
    virtual ~UnitCircle() {}

    /// Position vector, r, to the point on the circle identified by
    /// its 1D Lagrangian coordinate, xi (passed as a 1D Vector):
    void position(const Vector<double>& xi, Vector<double>& r) const
    {
        // Eulerian position vector
        r[0] = cos(xi[0]);
        r[1] = sin(xi[0]);
    }

    /// Position vector, r, to the point on the circle identified by
    /// its 1D Lagrangian coordinate, xi (passed as a 1D Vector) at discrete time
    /// level t (t=0: present; t>0: previous). The shape of the object
    /// is not time-dependent, therefore we forward this call to the
    /// steady version.
    void position(const unsigned& t, const Vector<double>& xi,
                  Vector<double>& r) const
    {
        position(xi,r);
    }
}; // end of unit circle class
```

[The dummy time-dependent version of the `position(...)` function is required to stop the compiler from complaining about "only partially overridden" virtual functions].

1.2.2 Domains

`GeomObjects` provide a natural way of representing a `Domain`'s curvilinear boundaries. For instance, the fish's body in D_{fish} is bounded by two circular arcs. These may be represented by `GeomObjects` of type `Circle` – a slight generalisation of the `UnitCircle` class shown above. The `FishDomain` constructor therefore takes a pointer to a 2D `GeomObject` and the "start" and "end" values of the Lagrangian coordinate along this object. The `GeomObject` represents the curvilinear boundary of the fish's (upper) body and the two coordinates represent the Lagrangian coordinates of the "nose" and the "tail" on this `GeomObject`, as shown in this sketch:

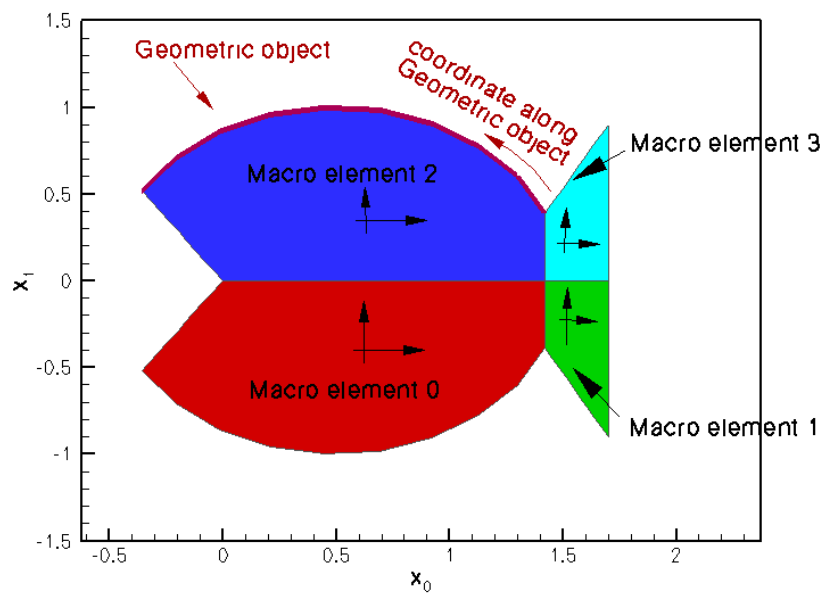


Figure 1.4 The fish-shaped domain and its MacroElement-based representation by the FishDomain object. The arrows show the orientation of the MacroElements' local coordinate systems.

To construct a FishDomain whose curvilinear boundaries are arcs of unit circles, centred at $(x_0, x_1) = (1/2, 0)$ we create a GeomObject of type Circle, passing the appropriate parameters to its constructor:

```
// Fish back is a circle of radius 1, centred at (0.5,0.0)
double x_c=0.5;
double y_c=0.0;
double r_back=1.0;
GeomObject* back_pt=new Circle(x_c,y_c,r_back);
```

Next, we pass the (pointer to the) Circle object to the constructor of the FishDomain, locating the "nose end" of the fish's back at $\xi = 2.4$ and its "tail end" at $\xi = 0.4$:

```
double xi_nose=2.6;
double xi_tail=0.4;
Domain* domain_pt=new FishDomain(back_pt,xi_nose,xi_tail);
```

To see how this works internally, let us have a look at the FishDomain constructor. The constructor stores the pointer to the fish's "back", and the start and end values of the Lagrangian coordinates in the private data members Back_pt, Xi_nose and Xi_tail. Next we set some additional parameters, that define the geometry (the mouth is located at the origin; the fin is a vertical line at $x = 1.7$, ranging from $y = -0.9$ to $y = +0.9$). Finally, we allocate storage for the four MacroElements and build them. Note that the constructor of the MacroElement takes a pointer to the Domain, and the MacroElement's number within that Domain:

```
/// Constructor: Pass pointer to GeomObject that represents the
/// (upper) curved boundary of the fish's body, and the start and end values
/// of the Lagrangian coordinates along the GeomObject.
FishDomain(GeomObject* back_pt,
           const double& xi_nose,
           const double& xi_tail)
: Xi_nose(xi_nose), Xi_tail(xi_tail), Back_pt(back_pt)
{
    // Set values for private data members that describe
    // geometric features of the fish: x-coordinate of the fin,
    // (half-)height of the fin, and x-position of the mouth.
    X_fin = 1.7;
    Y_fin = 0.9;
    X_mouth = 0.0;

    // There are four macro elements
    unsigned nmacro = 4;
    Macro_element_pt.resize(nmacro);

    // Build them
    for (unsigned i = 0; i < nmacro; i++)
    {
        Macro_element_pt[i] = new QMacroElement<2>(this, i);
    }
} // end of constructor
```

Most of the remaining public member functions are equally straightforward. We provide various access functions to the geometric parameters such as X_mouth, etc – we will not list these explicitly. All the "real work" is done in the

implementation of the pure virtual function `Domain::macro_element_boundary(...)`. Given

- the number of the `MacroElement` in its `Domain`
- the direction of its boundary (N[orth], S[outh], E[ast], W[est], enumerated in the namespace `QuadTreeNames`)

this function must compute the vector $\mathbf{r}(\zeta)$ to the `MacroElement`'s boundary. Here $\zeta \in [-1, 1]$ is the 1D coordinate along the element boundary, aligned with the direction of the `MacroElement`'s 2D coordinates (s_0, s_1) as indicated in this sketch:

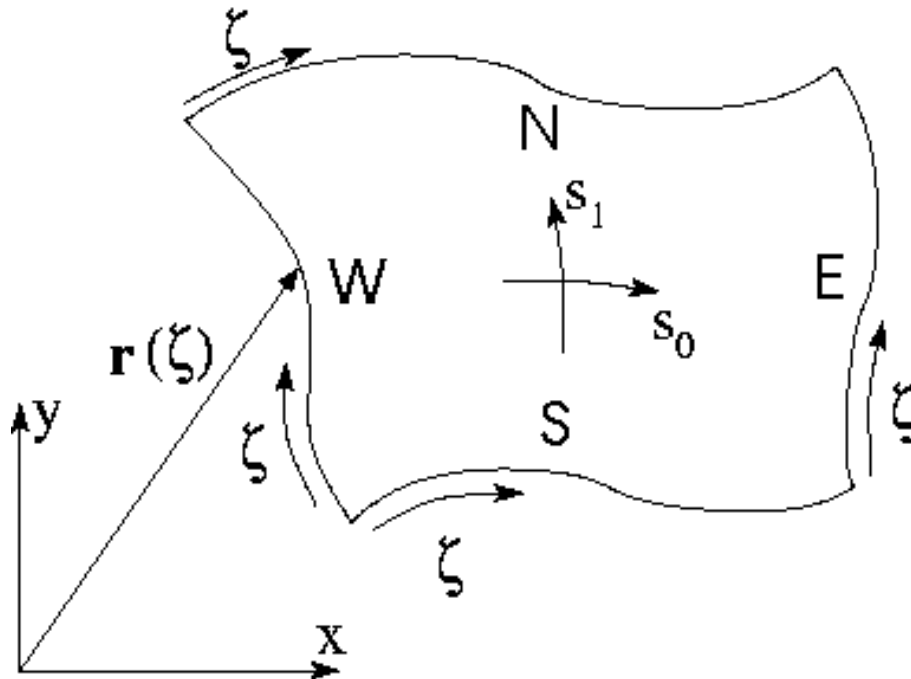


Figure 1.5 Sketch illustrating the parametrisation of the `MacroElement`'s four boundaries.

Since the shape of the domain can evolve in time, the full interface for the function includes an additional parameter, t , which indicates the (discrete) time level at which the domain shape is to be evaluated. If $t=0$ the function computes the domain shape at the current time; if $t>0$ it computes the shape at the t -th previous timestep. ([Another example](#) in which we solve the unsteady heat equation in a moving domain, provides a more detailed discussion of this aspect.) Here is the full interface for the `FishDomain::macro_element_boundary(...)` function:

```
/// Vector representation of the i_macro-th macro element
/// boundary i_direct (N/S/W/E) at the discrete time level t
/// (t=0: present; t>0: previous): \f$ {\bf r}({\bf zeta}) \f$
/// Note that the local coordinate \b zeta is a 1D
/// Vector rather than a scalar -- this is unavoidable because
/// this function implements the pure virtual function in the
/// Domain base class.
void macro_element_boundary(const unsigned& t,
                           const unsigned& i_macro,
                           const unsigned& i_direct,
                           const Vector<double>& zeta,
                           Vector<double>& r);
```

The implementation of this function is the only tedious task that needs to be performed by the "mesh writer". Once `Domain::macro_element_boundary(...)` is implemented, the `Domain`'s constituent `MacroElements` can refer to this function to establish the positions of their boundaries (recall that we passed the pointer to the `Domain` and the `MacroElement`'s number in the `Domain` to the `MacroElement` constructor). The `MacroElement::macro_map(...)` functions interpolate the position of the `MacroElement`'s boundaries into their interior.

To illustrate the general procedure, here is the complete listing of the `FishDomain::macro_element_boundary(...)` function. The function employs switch statements to identify the private member functions that provide the parametrisation of individual `MacroElement` boundaries. Some of these functions are listed below.

```
=====start_of_macro_element_boundary=====
/// Vector representation of the imacro-th macro element
```

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```
/// boundary idirect (N/S/W/E) at time level t
/// (t=0: present; t>0: previous): \f$ {\bf r}({\bf zeta}) \f$
/// Note that the local coordinate \b zeta is a 1D
/// Vector rather than a scalar -- this is unavoidable because
/// this function implements the pure virtual function in the
/// Domain base class.
//=====
void FishDomain::macro_element_boundary(const unsigned& t,
                                       const unsigned& imacro,
                                       const unsigned& idirect,
                                       const Vector<double>& zeta,
                                       Vector<double>& r)
{
    using namespace QuadTreeNames;

#ifdef WARN_ABOUT_SUBTLY_CHANGED_OOMPH_INTERFACES
    // Warn about time argument being moved to the front
    OomphLibWarning(
        "Order of function arguments has changed between versions 0.8 and 0.85",
        "FishDomain::macro_element_boundary(...)",
        OOMPH_EXCEPTION_LOCATION);
#endif

    // Which macro element?
    // -----
    switch (imacro)
    {
        // Macro element 0: Lower body
        case 0:

            // Which direction?
            if (idirect == N)
            {
                FishDomain::r_lower_body_N(t, zeta, r);
            }
            else if (idirect == S)
            {
                FishDomain::r_lower_body_S(t, zeta, r);
            }
            else if (idirect == W)
            {
                FishDomain::r_lower_body_W(t, zeta, r);
            }
            else if (idirect == E)
            {
                FishDomain::r_lower_body_E(t, zeta, r);
            }
            else
            {
                std::ostringstream error_stream;
                error_stream << "idirect is " << idirect << " not one of N, S, E, W"
                            << std::endl;

                throw OomphLibError(error_stream.str(),
                                    OOMPH_CURRENT_FUNCTION,
                                    OOMPH_EXCEPTION_LOCATION);
            }

            break;

        // Macro element 1: Lower Fin
        case 1:

            // Which direction?
            if (idirect == N)
            {
                FishDomain::r_lower_fin_N(t, zeta, r);
            }
            else if (idirect == S)
            {
                FishDomain::r_lower_fin_S(t, zeta, r);
            }
            else if (idirect == W)
            {
                FishDomain::r_lower_fin_W(t, zeta, r);
            }
            else if (idirect == E)
            {
                FishDomain::r_lower_fin_E(t, zeta, r);
            }
            else
            {
                std::ostringstream error_stream;
                error_stream << "idirect is " << idirect << " not one of N, S, E, W"
```

```

        « std::endl;

        throw OomphLibError(error_stream.str(),
                            OOMPH_CURRENT_FUNCTION,
                            OOMPH_EXCEPTION_LOCATION);
    }

    break;

    // Macro element 2: Upper body
case 2:

    // Which direction?
    if (idirect == N)
    {
        FishDomain::r_upper_body_N(t, zeta, r);
    }
    else if (idirect == S)
    {
        FishDomain::r_upper_body_S(t, zeta, r);
    }
    else if (idirect == W)
    {
        FishDomain::r_upper_body_W(t, zeta, r);
    }
    else if (idirect == E)
    {
        FishDomain::r_upper_body_E(t, zeta, r);
    }
    else
    {
        std::ostringstream error_stream;
        error_stream « "idirect is " « indirect « " not one of N, S, E, W"
                    « std::endl;

        throw OomphLibError(error_stream.str(),
                            OOMPH_CURRENT_FUNCTION,
                            OOMPH_EXCEPTION_LOCATION);
    }

    break;

    // Macro element 3: Upper Fin
case 3:

    // Which direction?
    if (idirect == N)
    {
        FishDomain::r_upper_fin_N(t, zeta, r);
    }
    else if (idirect == S)
    {
        FishDomain::r_upper_fin_S(t, zeta, r);
    }
    else if (idirect == W)
    {
        FishDomain::r_upper_fin_W(t, zeta, r);
    }
    else if (idirect == E)
    {
        FishDomain::r_upper_fin_E(t, zeta, r);
    }
    else
    {
        std::ostringstream error_stream;
        error_stream « "idirect is " « indirect « " not one of N, S, E, W"
                    « std::endl;

        throw OomphLibError(error_stream.str(),
                            OOMPH_CURRENT_FUNCTION,
                            OOMPH_EXCEPTION_LOCATION);
    }

    break;

default:

    // Error
    std::ostringstream error_stream;
    error_stream « "Wrong imacro " « imacro « std::endl;

    throw OomphLibError(
        error_stream.str(), OOMPH_CURRENT_FUNCTION, OOMPH_EXCEPTION_LOCATION);

```

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```
}
```

```
} // end of macro_element_boundary
```

Here are a few of the private member functions that define individual MacroElement boundaries:

- The N[orthern] boundary of macro element 2 (which represents the upper body) coincides with the domain boundary that is parametrised by the geometric object pointed to by Back_pt. The function translates the coordinate $\zeta \in [-1, 1]$ to the Lagrangian coordinate $\xi \in [\xi_{nose}, \xi_{tail}]$ along the geometric object. We use this Lagrangian coordinate to obtain the position vector to the domain boundary via a call to the `GeomObject::position(...)` function of the geometric object pointed to by Back_pt:

```
//=====start_of_r_upper_body_N=====
/// Northern edge of upper body macro element; \f$ \zeta \in [-1,1] \f$
//=====
void FishDomain::r_upper_body_N(const unsigned& t,
                                const Vector<double>& zeta,
                                Vector<double>& r)
{
    // Lagrangian coordinate along curved "back"
    Vector<double> x(1);
    x[0] = Xi_nose + (Xi_tail - Xi_nose) * 0.5 * (zeta[0] + 1.0);

    // Get position on curved back
    Back_pt->position(t, x, r);
} // end of r_upper_body_N
```

- The E[astern] boundary of macro element 2 is a straight vertical line from the "tail end" of the curved fish back to the x-axis:

```
//=====start_of_r_upper_body_E=====
/// Eastern edge of upper body macro element; \f$ \zeta \in [-1,1] \f$
//=====
void FishDomain::r_upper_body_E(const unsigned& t,
                                const Vector<double>& zeta,
                                Vector<double>& r)
{
    // Top right corner (tail end) of body
    Vector<double> r_top(2);
    Vector<double> x(1);
    x[0] = Xi_tail;
    Back_pt->position(t, x, r_top);

    // Corresponding point on the x-axis
    Vector<double> r_back(2);
    r_back[0] = r_top[0];
    r_back[1] = 0.0;

    r[0] = r_back[0] + (r_top[0] - r_back[0]) * 0.5 * (zeta[0] + 1.0);
    r[1] = r_back[1] + (r_top[1] - r_back[1]) * 0.5 * (zeta[0] + 1.0);
} // end of r_upper_body_E
```

- The S[outhern] boundary of macro element 2 is a straight horizontal line from the "mouth" to the end of the body:

```
//=====start_of_r_upper_body_S=====
/// Southern edge of upper body macro element; \f$ \zeta \in [-1,1] \f$
//=====
void FishDomain::r_upper_body_S(const unsigned& t,
                                const Vector<double>& zeta,
                                Vector<double>& r)
{
    // Top right (tail) corner of fish body
    Vector<double> r_top(2);
    Vector<double> x(1);
    x[0] = Xi_tail;
    Back_pt->position(t, x, r_top);

    // Straight line from mouth to start of fin (=end of body)
    r[0] = X_mouth + (r_top[0] - X_mouth) * 0.5 * (zeta[0] + 1.0);
    r[1] = 0.0;
} // end of r_upper_body_S
```

- The W[estern] boundary of macro element 2 is a straight line from the "mouth" to the "mouth" end of the curved upper boundary of the body:

```
//=====start_of_r_upper_body_W=====
/// Western edge of upper body macro element; \f$ \zeta \in [-1,1] \f$
//=====
void FishDomain::r_upper_body_W(const unsigned& t,
                                const Vector<double>& zeta,
                                Vector<double>& r)
```

```

{
    // Top left (mouth) corner of curved boundary of upper body
    Vector<double> r_top(2);
    Vector<double> x(1);
    x[0] = Xi_nose;
    Back_pt->position(t, x, r_top);

    // The "mouth"
    Vector<double> r_mouth(2);
    r_mouth[0] = X_mouth;
    r_mouth[1] = 0.0;

    // Straight line from mouth to leftmost corner on curved boundary
    // of upper body
    r[0] = r_mouth[0] + (r_top[0] - r_mouth[0]) * 0.5 * (zeta[0] + 1.0);
    r[1] = r_mouth[1] + (r_top[1] - r_mouth[1]) * 0.5 * (zeta[0] + 1.0);

} // end of r_upper_body_W

```

- The S[outhern] boundary of macro element 0 (which represents the lower body) is simply a reflection of the N[orthern] boundary of macro element 2:

```

/// Southern boundary of lower body macro element zeta \f$ in [-1,1] \f$
void r_lower_body_S(const unsigned& t,
                   const Vector<double>& zeta,
                   Vector<double>& f)
{
    // South of lower body is element is north of upper one.
    // Direction of the coordinate stays the same.
    r_upper_body_N(t, zeta, f);
    // Reflect vertical position
    f[1] = -f[1];
}

```

- etc.

Tedious? Yes! Rocket Science? No!

1.3 Further comments

1.3.1 Node updates in response to changes in the Domain shape.

You may have noticed that, even though we introduced `MacroElements` in the context of adaptive mesh refinement, the pointer to a refineable element's `MacroElement` is stored in the `FiniteElement`, rather than the (derived) `RefineableElement` class, suggesting that `MacroElements` have additional uses outside the context of mesh adaptation. Indeed, the code fragment that illustrated the use of `Domains` and `MacroElements` during mesh generation, was taken from the constructor of the *non-refineable* `FishMesh`, rather than its adaptive counterpart. During the mesh generation process, the `FiniteElement`'s `MacroElement` representation was used to determine the position of its `Nodes` within the `Domain`. The same procedure can be employed to *update* the nodal positions in response to changes in the domain shape. This is implemented, generically, in the function

```
Mesh::node_update()
```

This function loops over all elements in a `Mesh` and updates their nodal positions in response to changes in the domain boundary. (If the `Mesh`'s constituent elements are not associated with `MacroElements` and if the `Mesh` does not implement the node update by other means, this function does not change the mesh.)

The following code fragment illustrates the trivial modifications to the driver code required to compute the solution of Poisson's equation in fish-shaped domain of various widths. We simply change the position of the `GeomObject` that specifies the curvilinear boundary (by changing the position of the circle's centre), call the `Mesh::node_update()` function, and recompute the solution.

```

//=====start_of_main=====
/// Demonstrate how to solve 2D Poisson problem in
/// fish-shaped domain with black-box mesh adaptation
/// and domain updates in response to changes in the domain
/// shape.
//=====
int main()
{
    //Set up the problem with 9 node refineable Poisson elements
    RefineableFishPoissonProblem<RefineableQPoissonElement<2,3> > problem;
    // Setup labels for output
    //-----
    DocInfo doc_info;
    // Set output directory
    doc_info.set_directory("RESLT");
    // Adjust the domain shape by changing the width of the fish
    //-----

```

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```
unsigned nstep=3;
for (unsigned i=0;i<nstep;i++)
{
    // Get pointer to GeomObject that defines the position of the
    // fish's back:
    GeomObject* fish_back_pt=problem.mesh_pt()->fish_back_pt();

    // Recast to pointer to Circle object to get access to the member function
    // that sets the y-position of the Circle's centre and decrease its
    // value, making the fish narrower
    dynamic_cast<Circle*>(fish_back_pt)->y_c()-=0.1;

    // Update the domain shape in response to the changes in its
    // boundary
    problem.mesh_pt()->node_update();

    // Solve the problem, allowing for up to two levels of refinement
    problem.newton_solve(2);

    //Output solution
    problem.doc_solution(doc_info);

    //Increment counter for solutions
    doc_info.number()++;
}
} // end of main
```

The rest of the code remains unchanged. Here is a plot of the solution for various widths of the domain (computed with nine-node elements).

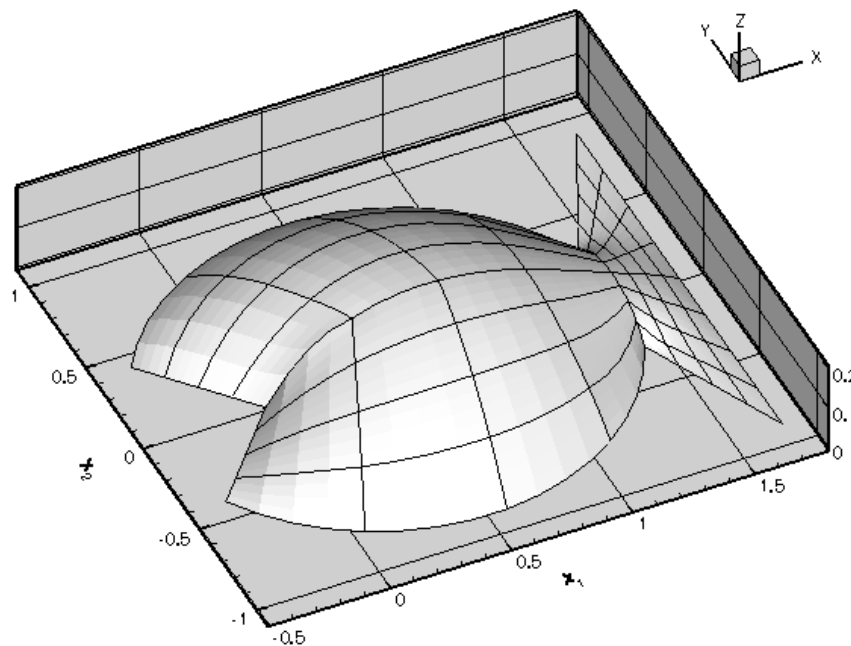


Figure 1.6 Adaptive solution of Poisson's equation in fish-shaped domains of varying width.

1.3.2 Good practice: Storing boundary coordinates

The above example demonstrated how the representation of curvilinear domain boundaries by `GeomObjects` allows `oomph-lib`'s mesh generation and adaptation procedures to place nodes on these boundaries. We note that the Lagrangian coordinate(s) that parametrise(s) the relevant `GeomObjects` also provide a parametrisation of the corresponding domain boundaries. In certain applications (such as free-boundary or fluid-structure interaction problems) it is useful to have direct access to these boundary coordinates. For this purpose the `Node` class provides the function

```
Node::set_coordinates_on_boundary(const unsigned& b,
                                  const Vector<double>& xi);
```

which allows the mesh writer to store the (vector of) boundary coordinates that a given (`Boundary`)`Node` is located at. The argument `b` specifies the number of the mesh boundary, reflecting the fact that nodes may be located on multiple domain boundaries, each of which is likely to have a different set of surface coordinates. **[Note:** The function is implemented as a broken virtual function in the `Node` base class. The actual functionality to store

boundary coordinates is only provided in (and required by) the derived `BoundaryNode` class.]

Since the storage of boundary coordinates is optional, the `Mesh` base class provides a protected vector of bools, `std::vector<bool> Mesh::Boundary_coordinate_exists;`

that indicates if the boundary coordinates have been stored for all `Nodes` on a specific mesh boundary. This vector is resized and its entries are initialised to `false`, when the number of mesh boundaries is declared with a call to `Mesh::set_nboundary(...)`. If, during mesh refinement, a new `BoundaryNode` is created on the mesh's boundary `b`, its boundary coordinates are computed by interpolation from the corresponding values at the nodes in the father element, if `Mesh::Boundary_coordinate_exists[b]` has been set to `true`.

We regard it as good practice to set boundary coordinates for all `BoundaryNodes` that are located on curvilinear mesh boundaries. The source code `fish_mesh.template.cc` for the refineable `FishMesh` illustrates the methodology.

1.4 Source files for this tutorial

- The source files for this tutorial are located in the directory:

`demo_drivers/poisson/fish_poisson2/`

- The driver code is:

`demo_drivers/poisson/fish_poisson2/fish_poisson_adapt.cc`

1.5 PDF file

A [pdf version](#) of this document is available.